

Travel health Action Sheet

Nigeria · Abuja, Nigeria → Lagaps, Nigeria · 90 days · Leisure
May 6, 2026

SECTION 1: CRITICAL ACTIONS BEFORE DEPARTURE

- Book a travel medicine consultation immediately do not delay as several vaccines require lead time before departure (yellow fever must be given at least 10 days before arrival in Nigeria).
- Bring any available vaccination records to your consultation so the clinician can identify gaps and avoid unnecessary repeat doses.
- Obtain a prescription for malaria chemoprophylaxis and arrange a full 90 day supply before departure do not rely on sourcing this in Nigeria.
- Discuss rabies pre exposure prophylaxis with your clinician a 3 dose series is recommended given the 90 day duration and planned outdoor activities.

SECTION 2: TRIP SNAPSHOT

With friends, 90 days, Leisure, overall risk HIGH

SECTION 3: VACCINES

No qualifying vaccines listed in dossier.

SECTION 4: WHAT TO PACK AND DAILY ROUTINE

- Malaria prophylaxis: Atovaquone proguanil (Malarone) or doxycycline discuss with clinician for final selection. Nigeria has one of the highest malaria burdens in the world, with year round transmission of Plasmodium falciparum throughout the country including Abuja and Lagos. Chemoprophylaxis is strongly recommended for all non immune travellers and for Nigerian nationals who have been residing outside Nigeria and may have lost partial immunity. Atovaquone proguanil (Malarone) is well tolerated, has a favourable side effect profile, and requires only 1 to 2 days of post travel dosing. Doxycycline is an effective and lower cost alternative but requires strict sun protection due to photosensitivity and must be taken daily. Mefloquine is an option for 90 day stays due to weekly dosing convenience but is not preferred given the neuropsychiatric side effect profile and the availability of better tolerated alternatives. Your clinician will confirm the most appropriate agent based on your full medical history. A 90 day supply must be arranged before departure as reliable sourcing in Nigeria cannot be guaranteed.
- Pre travel review and vaccination records: James has no primary care physician on record and is uncertain about his travel vaccine history. It is essential to book a travel medicine consultation as soon as possible before departure. Bring any available vaccination records. Priority vaccines for this trip include yellow fever (required for entry), typhoid, hepatitis A, hepatitis B, meningococcal, rabies pre exposure, and a polio booster. Routine vaccines (MMR, Tdap) should be verified and updated. Allow sufficient lead time: yellow fever must be given at least 10 days before arrival, and some vaccine series require multiple doses over several weeks.
- Food and water hygiene: In both Abuja and Lagos, tap water is not reliably safe to drink. Drink only bottled water from sealed containers or water that has been boiled and cooled. Avoid ice in drinks unless you are certain it was made from safe water. Eat only thoroughly cooked food served hot. Avoid raw salads, unpeeled fruit, and street food from vendors with poor hygiene standards. Wash hands thoroughly with soap and water

before eating and after using the toilet. Carry alcohol based hand sanitiser (at least 60 percent alcohol) for situations where handwashing is not possible. Be particularly vigilant during the 90 day stay as cumulative exposure increases risk.

- **Vector bite prevention:** Malaria is the primary vector borne threat and is present year round in Nigeria. Apply DEET repellent (30 to 50 percent) to all exposed skin from dusk onwards. Wear permethrin treated long clothing during evening outdoor activities and hiking. Sleep under an insecticide treated bed net. Dengue fever is also present in Nigeria and is transmitted by day biting Aedes mosquitoes, so daytime repellent use is also important. There is no vaccine for dengue currently recommended for travellers to Nigeria. Avoid areas of stagnant water where mosquitoes breed.
- **Sun, heat, and environmental precautions:** Nigeria has a hot, humid tropical climate. Acclimatise gradually during the first week, especially before undertaking hiking or strenuous outdoor activities. Stay well hydrated with safe water throughout the day. Apply SPF50 or higher broad spectrum sunscreen to all exposed skin and reapply every 2 hours during outdoor activities. Wear a wide brimmed hat and UV protective sunglasses. Avoid prolonged outdoor exertion during peak heat hours (11am to 3pm). Be aware that Lagos has significant urban air pollution those with respiratory sensitivities should monitor air quality and limit outdoor exposure on high pollution days.
- **Injury and road safety:** Road traffic injuries are a leading cause of death and serious injury for travellers in Nigeria. Use only reputable, licensed transport providers. Always wear a seatbelt. Avoid travelling by road at night where possible. If hiring a vehicle, ensure it is roadworthy and insured. During hiking and outdoor activities, use appropriate footwear, stay on marked trails where available, and inform someone of your planned route and expected return time. Carry a basic first aid kit. Be aware of personal security risks in Lagos in particular avoid displaying valuables, use hotel safes, and follow current Foreign Office or embassy security advisories for Nigeria.
- **Sexual health and blood exposure:** HIV prevalence in Nigeria is significant, and hepatitis B is hyperendemic. If engaging in any sexual activity during the trip, consistent use of condoms is strongly advised. Ensure hepatitis B vaccination is complete before departure. Avoid tattooing, piercing, acupuncture, or any medical or cosmetic procedures in facilities where sterile equipment cannot be verified. In the event of a needlestick injury or potential blood exposure, seek medical attention immediately and discuss post exposure prophylaxis (PEP) for HIV PEP must be started within 72 hours of exposure to be effective. Confirm that your travel insurance covers emergency medical treatment including blood borne virus exposure management.
- **Jet lag, sleep, and mental wellbeing:** As a Nigerian national currently residing in Nigeria, jet lag is not anticipated for this domestic equivalent trip. However, a 90 day stay away from home with friends can still present psychological challenges including social fatigue, changes in routine, and potential culture adjustment if moving between significantly different urban environments. Maintain regular sleep patterns, stay socially connected, and be aware of signs of stress or low mood. If you experience persistent low mood, anxiety, or difficulty coping, seek support from a healthcare provider. Ensure your travel insurance includes mental health coverage.

SECTION 5: RED FLAGS AND EMERGENCY CONTACTS

URGENT: Any fever within 3 months of return from Nigeria must be assessed as a medical emergency malaria can be fatal within 24 to 48 hours if untreated. Do not wait. Go to an emergency department and state that you have recently returned from Nigeria.

CLINICAL FACILITIES

National Hospital Abuja, Central Business District, Abuja, FCT, Nigeria

Lagos University Teaching Hospital (LUTH), Ishaga Road, Idi Araba, Lagos, Nigeria

LOCAL EMERGENCY NUMBER

112 or 199

INSURANCE

Insurance: Yes travel insurance confirmed

Full clinical dossier attached. Share with your travel medicine clinician at your pre-travel appointment.